

MSCF Career Services Student Code of Conduct

In order to participate in recruiting services offered by MSCF Career Services, you must adhere to the following rules of conduct. All students must uphold themselves to the highest ethical standards while participating on- and off-campus recruiting. Failure to do so will jeopardize MSCF's premiere reputation with our employers and result in the loss of career services for you.

This document must be read in its entirety, signed, and dated by you. Your signature attests to your having read and understood these rules and policies contained herein and your agreement to adhere to these rules and policies throughout your time in the MSCF program.

UTILIZATION OF MSCF CAREER SERVICES

1. Will you be seeking employment (either a summer internship or full-time employment, dependent upon your current academic level)? Yes____ No____

- If you answered **YES**, please continue reading all sections, **initial each page**, and sign on page 4.
- If you answered **NO**, please skip to page 5, complete the page, and sign.

RECRUITING REQUIREMENTS

Ethical Standards

- All students are expected to represent themselves and the MSCF program with personal and professional integrity, exhibiting honest and transparent behavior in all aspects of their job search.

MSCF QPA Disclosure Policy

- Students may include their MSCF QPA from all Minis (you may begin to include QPA after you receive grades from Mini 2). You must report your QPA as it appears on your transcript (e.g., X.XX/4.33) but should only include grades from MSCF courses (see bullet below for further explanation). If you have to/choose to input your QPA in an online application that requires you to use a 4.0 scale, or your QPA is higher than 4.0 and the online system will not allow you to input higher than 4.0, you must convert your current MSCF QPA to a 4.0 scale. A conversion tool is available on the MSCF Career Services page in Canvas.
- MSCF permits students to take non-MSCF classes for a grade. Students may, at their option, show both the MSCF QPA (only include MSCF courses) and the University QPA (per your transcript) on their resumes but must identify each. If you show only one QPA, it must be your MSCF QPA. Students must provide their MSCF QPA when applying for jobs on employer websites.
- MSCF Career Services is not responsible for auditing the MSCF QPA on your resume but can impose penalties upon students who have not correctly represented their academic achievements on their resumes, in online applications or discussions with employers.

Recruiting Opportunities Available for MSCF Students

- You may participate in On-Campus Recruiting (OCR), including using QuantConnect to search and apply for jobs as well as interview on-campus, for one academic year to seek a summer internship and for one academic year for a full-time job search. The full-time job search must take place during the academic year leading up to your graduation. One year after your graduation date, you are eligible for MSCF Alumni Career Services.
- **Students on academic probation will lose access to MSCF Career Services; you may still meet with your Career Counselor.**

Applications and Correspondence

- Your resume, cover letters, networking emails, and other career-related documents and application materials must contain no false information and must, to the best of your ability, be error free.

- You must use the MSCF resume template given to you by MSCF Career Services.
- You may only apply for jobs or internships that are of genuine interest to you.
- Whether or not you have an interest in a particular company, you must respond to any employer correspondence in a professional manner within 48 hours.
- Job/internship postings and job/internship resources are for MSCF students only. You may not give out passwords or job descriptions to individuals not affiliated with MSCF.
- All communications with MSCF and other CMU alumni, either in person, over the phone, or by email must be respectful, timely, and professional. You must adhere to the University guidelines for utilizing the online alumni directories as found at <http://www.cmu.edu/alumni/footer/privacy.html>.

Corporate Presentations/On-Campus Events

- Attend all events for which you have RSVP'd. It is expected that you will attend, be on time, follow the required dress code, and stay until the event is over unless you cancel your RSVP at least two business days before the event.
- Exhibit respectful behavior as an audience member; do not text or email during a presentation or event. The use of laptops and phones is prohibited.
- Students who are late or who are not dressed according to the dress code will be asked to leave.
- You may only sign-in for yourself. Signing in for another is cheating! Both the one signing and the one who was signed for will be subject to penalties.

Counseling Appointments

- Apart from genuine emergencies, if you are unable to keep a scheduled appointment with your Career Counselor, you must cancel the appointment 24 hours prior to the appointment time by calling or emailing your Career Counselor or canceling via QuantConnect. Failure to do so will result in discipline at the discretion of your Career Counselor.

Interview Protocol

- You must not interview for positions in which you have no interest. Interviewing “for practice” wastes the recruiter’s time and may take away a valuable interviewing experience from a fellow student who *is* interested in the position.
- Prepare appropriately for all interviews by carefully reading the job description, learning about the company, researching the industry, and networking with company alumni. You should also practice answering behavioral questions and brainteasers and be comfortable discussing the financial markets. ***Be sure you can justify/explain everything on your resume.***
- Attend all scheduled interviews on time and wear business professional attire (unless otherwise directed by the employer).
- Cancel interviews you are not able to attend at least two business days before the scheduled interview by emailing MSCF Career Services. This will give the employer the option to select a replacement candidate for the vacated interview slot.
- If you fail to cancel your interview at least two business days before, you must email MSCF Career Services and send an apology directly to the recruiter.

Job/Internship Offer Protocol

- You are required to notify MSCF Career Services within 24 hours of any verbal or written job offer you receive, whether or not you intend to accept the offer and irrespective of whether the offer stemmed from your own networking efforts or through school resources. ***Submitting offer information assists all students in evaluating and negotiating offers and can positively impact school rankings and admissions, thereby enhancing the value of your degree!***
 - o You should NOT wait until you receive written confirmation to report your offer; add it to the database upon receiving the verbal offer, even without all the details.
 - o You should NOT wait until you accept to report your offer.
 - o You should NOT wait until you pass the background check to report your accepted offer.

- Before accepting an offer, you should receive written confirmation with the details of your offer. Offer acceptances should be confirmed in writing. To provide students sufficient time to explore career options, we ask that employers extending return (full-time) offers to summer interns allow three weeks or until October 15 to respond, whichever is later. For offers generated from Fall recruiting, students should be given at least three weeks or until November 15, whichever is later. Employers extending offers resulting from Spring recruiting should provide students a minimum of three weeks to respond.
- Companies may or may not comply with MSCF Career Services guidelines. You should not wait until the offer deadline to ask for an extension. Your Career Counselor can assist you in negotiating an offer extension.

Reneging on a Job and/or Internship

- **Once you accept an offer, you must immediately discontinue all self-directed and school-facilitated job search activities.** It is unethical and in violation of the MSCF Career Services Student Code of Conduct to continue to submit applications or accept interview invitations. If, as a result of earlier efforts, you receive an invitation for an interview or a job offer, you must decline.
- You must honor an accepted job offer. It makes no difference whether the accepted job offer was found using school resources or through your own efforts. *Reneging means that you have accepted a job offer, either in writing or verbally, and thereafter renounce your acceptance. Reneging is unethical and dishonest and will significantly affect your professional reputation, the credibility of the MSCF program, and may compromise future job opportunities for all MSCF students with that employer!*

CONSEQUENCES FOR VIOLATING RECRUITING REQUIREMENTS

All violations will be reviewed by MSCF Career Services Review Board, consisting of the Career Counselors and Academic Advisors from New York and Pittsburgh. The following violations may result in penalties ranging from the loss of QuantConnect access to the loss of MSCF Career Services and University Career Services access for up to five years after graduation. The MSCF Steering Committee may review students for MSCF Career Services violations and impose additional penalties.

Exhibiting Unethical Behavior during the Recruiting Process

You will be penalized if you exhibit unethical behavior.

Failure to Cancel RSVP for Corporate Presentations Which Results in a No-Show

You will be penalized if you fail to cancel your RSVP at least two business days prior to the presentation. *After the first no-show, you will receive a warning; after the second no-show, you will not be permitted to attend any further corporate presentations.*

If you commit any of the following 3 offenses relating to Corporate Presentations and Recruiting Events, the penalties will apply in first, second, third order per descriptions shown below:

- Tardy to event
- Inappropriate dress to event
- Leave before event is over

First offense penalty: *A meeting with your Career Counselor to receive a (documented) warning regarding behavior. Email copy of warning (after face- to- face discussion) and email copy to Executive Director, Rick Bryant.*

Second offense penalty: *A face to face or Skype explanation between you and the Executive Director (Rick Bryant) explaining reasons for behavior. Final warning issued.*

Third offense penalty: *Lose access to QuantConnect and your resume will be removed from the resume book for two weeks.*

Signing in for Another Student during a Corporate Presentation or On-Campus Event

You will be penalized if you sign in for anyone other than yourself, or if you ask another student to sign you in to an event.

Trek Offenses

You must attend a Trek if you have signed up to participate. If you cannot attend, you must give us a 48-hour notice prior to the Trek or you will be considered a no-show which results in the following consequence.

No Show - *Lose access to QuantConnect and your resume will be removed from the resume book for two weeks.*

Tardy - *If you are late for a company visit during the Trek, you will not be permitted to participate in any of the other company visits during the Trek.*

Unprofessional Dress - *You will not be allowed to participate in the Trek and will be sent away immediately. (If you change into appropriate attire, you will be allowed to attend the other remaining company visits during the Trek.)*

Missed Interviews

You will be penalized if you cancel any interview less than two business days before a scheduled interview or fail to show for an interview.

Misrepresenting Your Identity or Qualifications

Misrepresenting any of your identity or qualifications (including your MSCF QPA), verbally or in writing, is a serious offense which will likely result in a harsh penalty.

Applying for Jobs/Interviewing for Jobs after Accepting an Internship or Job Offer

Continuing to apply for jobs and/or interview after accepting an offer is a serious offense which will likely result in a harsh penalty.

Reneging on an Internship or Job Offer

Reneging on an accepted job /internship offer is a serious offense which will result in a harsh penalty.

MSCF CAREER SERVICES APPEAL PROCESS:

If you do not wish to appeal the decision made by the MSCF Career Services Review Board, your penalty is effective the day you receive it. If you decide to appeal the decision, you have seven calendar days from the day the penalty was communicated to you by the MSCF Career Services Review Board to file an appeal to the Executive Director. If the Executive Director requests a meeting with you, it may be virtual or in person but must be completed within fourteen calendar days from the day the penalty was communicated to you by the MSCF Career Services Review Board.

The Executive Director may uphold, reduce, increase, or eliminate the penalty. The penalty will be imposed following the decision of the Executive Director.

CODE OF CONDUCT ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

By signing this form and initialing each page, you hereby acknowledge that you have read, understand, and agree to abide by the guidelines and requirements outlined in this Code of Conduct.

Student Signature

Date

Print Name Legibly

Email

UTILIZATION OF MSCF CAREER SERVICES

If you indicated on Page 1 that you will not be seeking employment, therefore not utilizing MSCF Career Services, please provide your reason below:

_____ My academic expenses are mostly or fully paid by my employer or a government agency AND as part of that agreement I am not permitted to seek new employment for a specified period of time. (Sometimes an exception can be made for a summer internship, but we will require an official letter of permission from your sponsor in order to participate in MSCF Career Services.) *If you are unsure whether or not you are sponsored, please speak with your Career Counselor before checking this option.*

My sponsor is _____.

_____ I am already employed and will not be seeking new employment

_____ I will be pursuing further education (please describe in the space provided below)

_____ I plan to focus on starting my own business

_____ I am not seeking employment for other reasons (please describe in the space provided below)

Only sign below if you are NOT utilizing MSCF Career Services. Please also complete the section at the top of this page.

Student Signature

Date

Print Name Legibly

Email